Cell division

Cells do not last forever. They grow old and eventually die, so they need to be replaced. For example, skin cells in humans get worn out and are replaced continually. The flaky bits of dry skin that you scrub away are made of dead skin cells. Underneath this skin, healthy new skin cells are ready to replace the lost cells.

Cells also make living things grow bigger or stronger, by producing more of themselves. For example, a plant grows taller and gets more leaves as new cells are made.

To make more of themselves, cells separate into two parts that are the same. This is called **cell division**. Its scientific name is **mitosis**.

☞ **1** Use the letters in the circle to complete these forms of the word *division*.

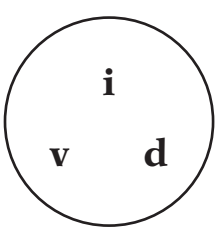
a) __ __ __ ide

b) __ __ __ ides

c) __ __ __ iding

d) __ __ __ ided

e) __ __ __ ision



2 Circle each of the correct phrases within the brackets to complete this explanation of mitosis.

Cells in living things make more of (themselves / proteins) in order to (renew / replace) old cells and (kill / create) new cells for growth. This process is called mitosis. Through mitosis, a (cell / plant) splits into (three / two), creating an (identical / adult) copy of itself.

3 Add the letters 'c' or 'e' to complete the words in this sentence, then rewrite the sentence in the space below.

Oth__r nam__s for mitosis ar__ __ __ll division and __ __ll r__produ__tion.

 ISBN 978 1 92571 063 2 © Ally Chumley and Blake Education 2014